



Muncie City Council August 3, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=GFTzrVfcqZ8
Publication Date	2026-08-04T14:25:01Z
Target Category	muncie_city

Notice: This report is provided by the [Muncie Policy Memo](#) as a public service. This summary is generated automatically using artificial intelligence from public video transcripts, both of which are prone to error. The report is intended to provide an overview of meeting business and an aid to accessing detailed information from the video recording. When accuracy is critical, please refer to the official video recording or approved minutes.

Municipal Meeting Report: Muncie Common Council

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding Officer called to order the Muncie Common Council meeting for August 3, 2026 [00:13:48](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Fasbender, Mason, Fishman, Garrett, Selvey, Goins, Howe, Green (and additional council members recorded during roll calls: Patterson, McCulloch, Dishman).
 - **Members Absent:** None noted (all present).
 - **Presiding Officer:** Council President Green.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:**
 - Pledge of Allegiance led by Mr. Basham [00:13:58](#).
 - Invocation/blessing given by Dr. Sandra Whitaker, former Muncie Community Schools administrator and current Muncie Ethics Council member [00:14:20](#).
 - Citizen of the Month presentation honoring Justin Oliver, assistant principal at Muncie Central High School and U.S. Iraq War veteran [00:15:25](#).

- **Approval of Minutes:**
 - Councilperson Selvey noted corrections to the July 6 meeting minutes regarding statements attributed to her versus Council President Green [00:22:09](#).
 - The amendment to correct the minutes passed by voice vote [00:23:15](#).
 - The minutes as amended were approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously) [00:23:39](#).
-

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- [00:33:01](#) **Resolution 8-26:**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Legal Counsel / Administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion regarding a proposed public hearing and responses from the controller's office. Counsel Murphy noted an agreement that the council would receive revised written responses by October 16, 2026.
 - **Action & Resolution:** A motion was made and seconded to adjourn and postpone the public hearing for Resolution 8-26 to a special meeting on November 16, 2026, at 7:00 p.m. Approved by Voice Vote [00:34:11](#).
- [00:35:41](#) **Ordinance 9-26:** Ordinance of the City of Muncie Approving Matters Related to Lease Financing a Fire Station Project (Fire Station No. 5).
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Administration / Chief Burford / Bob Swint (London Witty Group) / Mayor Ridenour.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Extensive debate concerning the \$11.5 million not-to-exceed bond financing, a \$1.5 million lump-sum contribution pledge from Ball State University, potential surplus/cushion funds, interest rates, and long-term city debt. Officials clarified that the \$1.5 million from Ball State would be applied to reduce total draws/debt rather than increasing the fire department's operating budget.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:**
 - *Audie Barber* [00:54:42](#) questioned whether the city has sufficient funds and noted past station bonding.
 - *Ken Smutsy Boyce* [00:56:16](#) criticized bond lawyer representation, stated Ball State Board of Trustees records show no formal vote on the \$1.5M, and raised concerns about closing costs and capitalized interest.
 - *Chafin (Firefighters Local 1348)* [00:07:10](#) spoke in favor, emphasizing a 6-year needs assessment and neighborhood pride.
 - *Rob Miller* [00:07:18](#) expressed concern over long-term fiscal health, declining property tax revenues, and future budget stress.
 - *Todd Smekens* [00:11:13](#) noted Muncie's S&P bond rating is near junk grade and warned against adding \$11.5M in debt.
 - *Terry Moore* [00:12:10](#) supported the station, noting only one fire station has been built in 60 years.

- *Sergeant Janay Jackson (Station 5)* 00:12:53 testified about deplorable living conditions at Station 5, including sewage backing up into drains and toilets.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed 7-2 via roll call vote (01:14:08; Council members McIntosh and Mason voted "No").
- 00:15:46 **Ordinance 14-26:** Ordinance Prohibiting Department Heads from Serving on Certain Boards and Commissions and Establishing Ethics and Conflict of Interest Standards.
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Councilperson Mason / Councilperson Selvey.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Council debated an amendment introduced by Councilperson Selvey to refine definitions regarding department heads, appointed officials, and administrative staff. Proponents argued the ordinance enhances public trust, prevents conflicts of interest, and ensures independent board decision-making. Opponents argued it unfairly restricts engaged municipal employees and targets specific individuals.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:**
 - *Linda McCrae* 00:16:31 supported the ordinance, noting its alignment with Human Rights Commission membership guidelines.
 - *Patty Yoder* 00:18:19 opposed the measure, stating existing ethics codes (Code 3724) suffice and municipal employees should be allowed to serve.
 - *Wayne Skafish* 00:13:46 supported the amendment and ordinance to maintain independence from the administration.
 - *Jeff Robinson (Shafer Leadership Academy)* 00:12:51 highlighted goservemuncie.com as a resource for connecting residents to boards and commissions.
 - *Ellen Whitehead* 01:30:55 and *Anita Wagner* 01:34:48 spoke in favor, emphasizing public trust and independent oversight.
 - *Rob Miller* 01:32:38 and *Oscar Kreider* 01:42:42 voiced support for curbing administrative influence on boards.
 - *Sam Johnson* 01:48:58 favored the ordinance to avoid the appearance of corruption.
 - *Chris Smith* 01:54:19 and *Cheyenne Reed* 01:39:38 commented on civic engagement and accessibility.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:**
 - Amendment defining scopes passed 5-4 via roll call vote 01:23:09.
 - Main Ordinance 14-26 (as amended) **Failed by Roll Call Vote** (4-5; vote failed to achieve majority) 02:14:35.
- 02:15:08 **Ordinance 15-26:** (*Zoning Ordinance*)
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Councilman Dishman moved to withdraw. Following legal advice that zoning ordinances require a council vote for withdrawal, the motion to withdraw passed by roll call vote 02:15:10.

- **02:16:10 Resolution 10-26:** Additional Appropriation Resolution Relating to Fire Station Number Five Project.
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council / Administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Brief procedural handling for additional appropriations regarding Station 5.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by roll call vote **02:16:30**.
- **02:18:14 Resolution 11-26:** Authorizing Entry into Agreement and Related Documents for Fire Station Number Five Project (Build-Operate-Transfer).
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Bond Counsel Jacob McLellan (Bose McKinney and Evans) / Developer Greg Martz (GM Development).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Explanation of the Build-Operate-Transfer (BOT) contract structure where developer Greg Martz manages construction, operates the facility temporarily, and transfers it back to the city under a fixed contract amount. Timeline discussed: 6 months design/temporary station construction, 14–16 months demolition and new station construction.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by roll call vote **02:22:12**.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

(General citizen comments delivered near the conclusion of the meeting regarding community centers, homelessness, and council procedures) - **02:24:11 Patty Goddard:** Addressed the council as HR Director regarding public servant treatment and professional decorum. - **02:28:08 Karen Brubaker:** Expressed disappointment over the defeat of Ordinance 14-26 and urged action on the Industry Neighborhood community center. - **02:29:31 Mr. Bilbrey:** Discussed constitutional rights to speak, email communication standards, and mutual respect between citizens and elected officials. - **02:32:27 Wayne Skafish:** Provided historical background on the Hope VI grant and the promised Industry Neighborhood community center. - **02:35:35 Rodney Vaughn:** Criticized the absence of the mayor during public comment and discussed the loss of youth and community centers in minority neighborhoods. - **02:38:39 Daisy Dale:** Inquired about the Civilian Review Board and address discrepancies for the community center memorandum. - **02:39:32 Dr. Chip Taylor:** Commended the transparency gained on Fire Station 5 questions and suggested improving board/commission website transparency and appointment scheduling. - **02:43:35 Cassandra Woods:** Spoke on behalf of Industry Neighborhood children, detailing the unfulfilled 2002 Hope VI grant promise for a community center and geographical/safety access issues with proposed alternate sites. - **02:47:02 Judith Hill:** Criticized the administration and council regarding unfulfilled neighborhood center promises and equity in neighborhood resource allocation. - **02:50:16 Paul Partizana:** Addressed statewide/national issues including unhoused populations, healthcare, and upcoming municipal/midterm election voting dates. - **02:51:48 Carl Malone:** President of Industry Neighborhood and Park Board member; recounted the 20-year history of promises to replace the Madison Street multi-use center and the positive impact

community programming previously had on youth. - [02:55:03](#) **Lynn Thornburg**: Commented on the intent behind board transparency ordinances and the growing crisis concerning unhoused individuals. - [02:56:44](#) **Audie Barber**: Criticized email responsiveness, council voting alignment, and adherence to public comment protocols. - [03:00:27](#) **Terry Moore**: Discussed school-based recreation history and decorum during public comment. - [03:01:50](#) **Jeanette Presley**: Peer recovery coach; spoke emotionally about the recent death of a homeless community member (Brian Bernard) due to gaps in medical and mental healthcare coverage. - [03:04:49](#) **Leslie McCurdy**: Voiced strong support for the Industry Neighborhood youth center and announced resignation from the committee if the center is not placed in the Industry neighborhood as originally voted (9-0).

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements**: None formally scheduled beyond ongoing budget season preparations and upcoming special meeting notices (Resolution 8-26 set for November 16, 2026).
 - **Adjournment**: Official motion to adjourn approved by voice vote at [03:05:47](#).
-

Muncie Policy Memo Civic Monitoring Automated Pipeline. Report generated on 2026-09-11 15:53:27 using model gemini-3.5-flash-lite.